

When planning a trip, travelers often consume an overwhelming number of blogs, vlogs, and recommendations. While it is easy to find the popular attraction, it is harder to discover authentic local experiences where communities actually live, eat, and interact.

As a student traveler, this problem becomes even more significant:

- Walking tours that combine food and history are often expensive.
- Popular destinations may not align with personal interests.
- Budget constraints limit trial-and-error exploration.
- Authentic cultural neighborhoods are often hidden behind tourist-heavy zones.

During a walking tour in Kolkata, I experienced how layered a city can be. A place that initially appeared to be just a busy market revealed unexpected cultural intersections. It had a Thai temple, Anglo-Indian communities, migrant influences which I would have missed without guided exploration. It showed how travel emerges from understanding local stories, not just visiting landmarks. This project aims to recreate that experience through an intelligent Virtual Assistant that is narration-driven with community anecdotes.

Questions:

1. "What are 5 cheap lunch spots near [Historic District] where locals actually eat?"
2. "I'm in [City] and have \$[Amount] for the day—suggest 3 activities and 2 meals."
3. "Which neighborhoods in [City] are best for seeing community-driven street art?"
4. "I want a free 'Instagram spot' in [City] that is culturally significant but not a tourist trap."
5. "What is a snack from a local eatery in [Neighborhood] that has been there for over 20 years?"
6. "Tell me about a 'cultural intersection' in [City] (e.g., a place where two different migrant communities met)."
7. "Plan a walking route from [Point A] to [Point B] with 2 stops that explain the city's history."
8. "I'm standing in front of [Landmark/Mural]—what is its significance to the local people living here today?"
9. "How has the [Neighborhood Name] changed in the last 50 years, and where can I still see the 'old' version?"
10. "Give me a 1-day plan for under \$[Budget] that includes history, local food, and a sunset."
11. "I land at [Airport] and need to get to [City Center]—what's the cheapest public transit vs. rideshare cost?"
12. "I have \$[Budget] for 3 days in [City] including stay—break down a feasible plan."
13. "Compare staying in a hostel vs. an Airbnb in [Neighborhood] for a student traveler."
14. "Is [Major Attraction] sold out this weekend, or is there a local alternative nearby?"
15. "I'm [Dietary Restriction] and want food under \$[Amount] near [Location]."
16. "(Image Upload): What is this building/statue and why should a student traveler care about it?"

17. "(Image Upload): I'm looking at this menu—which item is the most 'authentic' local specialty?"
18. "What's the weather in [City] tomorrow—should I plan for indoor museums or outdoor walking?"
19. "Is [Public Park/Monument] open today and is there a 'pay what you wish' day?"
20. "Find me the fastest transit route from [Current Location] to [Destination] using only local buses/trains."

Model	Parameters
Mistral Small 3 (24B)	~24 Billion
Phi-4 Mini (3.8B)	~3.8 Billion

- **Vector Database (ChromaDB/Pinecone):** Stores curated local stories, historical anecdotes, and "hidden gem" coordinates to ground the LLM in unique, non-generic facts.
- **Relational Database (PostgreSQL/SQLite):** Stores structured user profiles (budgets, preferences) and a vetted list of low-cost eateries/attractions with pricing.
- **Web Search Tool (Tavily/Google Search API):** Fetches real-time data like current weather, ticket availability, and transit delays.
- **Vision Tool:** Processes user-uploaded images to identify landmarks and murals.